

CFO Rare Bird Form

(1)

- Species (Common Name): Ruby-Throated Hummingbird
- Scientific Name: *Archilochus colubris*
- Date(s) of Observation: Oct 3, 5, 8, 9 and 10, 2011
- Number of birds seen: One
- Sex: Female
- Plumage: Immature
- Exact Location: 616 Kiwi Rd, Sterling, CO. Backyard
- County: Logan
- Elevation: 3935 ft MSL
- Length of Observation: Oct 3 - 4", Oct 5 - 10", Oct 8 - 15", Oct 9 - 10", Oct 10 - 55"
- Time of Observation: 36 observations total. Periods from 0800 - 1740. Longest period was 32".
- Other observers: None
- Light Conditions (quality, direction relative to bird(s) and observers position): Oct 3 .. CLR, sunny L 43° H 88°, Oct 5 .. CLR, sunny L 54° H 79° Wind SE 10-20 mph. Oct 8 and 9 .. L 43° L 41° H 52° H 46° Cloudy, OVC w RN SHRWS and DZ. Oct 10 .. CLR, sunny L 34° H 68° First observation on Oct 3 was 1616, 12 ft from 'Sunset Hyssop' flowers. 2nd observation was 41 ft from garage back door to flowers (binoc) looking north. 1715. Hung feeder that eve. Sightings on Oct 8, 9 and 10 were from garage back door to feeder hung on Russian Hawthorn Tree branch, distance of 21 ft. One sighting at flowers on Oct 9.
- Optical Equipment Used: Pentax 8x42 DCFWP binoc. Swarovski AT 65 20x60 HD spotting scope. Panasonic DMC-FZ10 4 MP 12x digital zoom camera.
- Distance to Bird(s): Initial sighting 12 ft. Garage door to feeder: 21 ft. " " TO flowers: 41 ft.
- Was (were) bird(s) photographed? : Yes 17 photos taken.
- Who Took Photograph(s)? : Observer
- Describe the general and specific habitats in which the bird(s) occurred: Backyard, suburb housing of Sterling, CO. Yard 55' x 75'. 6 ft privacy fence surrounding. Fence Right of way has 9 ft and lined with shrubs and trees. (See drawing) Have birdbath out year-round. No pets.
- Describe the bird(s) behavior(s) that were used to identify species: Two observations were made of bird feeding at the 'Sunset Hyssop' flowers (agastache rupestris). All others were of bird perched at feeder or in Hawthorn Tree. Did observe several hoverings of insect gleeking in the tree. I knew this was NOT a BTHU, RTHU or CAHU. My guess was RTHU. I contacted Joyce Takimine initially and sent photos for help. These were passed on to Tony Luekerling and John Vanderpoel. All leaned towards RTHU in all features but primaries. There was a hint of BCHU due to more rounded tip on P10. Photos weren't revealing enough. The final question concerned tail-pumping. I had to mull this over with previous observations in Aug and Sep of five BTHUs and one CAHU in the backyard. I ordered John's 'Hummers of N.A. DVD

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to get more knowledge of behavior and markings to ID the *Archilochus* species. My decision was tail pumping was not noticeable compared to BTHU or CAHU. Other observations of tail were fanning while hovering. One final inquiry was to Cornell Lab. I was told to go with the Ruby-throat. I did hear one call note while bird hovered. A nasal chirp.

- Describe bird(s) in detail: Overall... green/grayish topside, creamy buff underparts. Fork Tail.
Bill: black, medium length and straight. Lore and Crown: grayish
lore to mix of green at crown. Slightly scaly. Nape: green/golden green (relative to
sunlight) Post-ocular: white spot behind eye. Auricular: gray
Gorget and Foreneck: Creamy white, no markings. Just a hint of grayish shadow.
(V-shape bib) between chest and belly. Flanks: Light Tawney wash.
Back and Rump: green/golden green down to upper tail coverts and tips of R1.
Upper wing coverts: green to mix of gray on secondaries.
Primaries: P1 thru P10 gray/black. Uneven P1 thru P6. Curved with slight roundness
to wards P10. This was the tricky part. The tip of P10 on some photos show hints of
roundness, (as in BCHU) but a couple show evidence of pointed tip. One could make
a case for hybrid. Tail: R2 thru R5 upper tips green to black. Tips rounded.
R2 black lower tip. R3 partial white tip. R4 and R5 white lower tips.
- What is your prior experience with this and similar appearing species? I started
birding in 1998. Out of state species are Anna's and Costa's (male) in Arizona. Have
observed Broad-Tail and Black-chinned in Cortez, CO and Southern CO. Have seen
Calliope twice... 2001 in yard in Sterling (stayed 2 days) and 2011 here also. Rufous
have been observed here in Sterling and Brush, CO (male). ONE sighting of male in
Guernsey, WY. Ruby-throated... have only seen one male in Wisconsin. No
experience with them until the arrival on Oct 3rd. The key difference that
set this bird apart was the lack of Tawney/rust flanks and no rust color in upper
tail feathers. Initial assumption would be RUHU for the late season.
- List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced
your ID (during and after observation): National Geographic guide to NA birds, Kenn
Kaufman field guide, Peterson's field guide to NA birds and Sibley's. The Sibley guide
came to be what showed a perfect copy of what I observed (p. 299 Juvenile Jun-Dec ♀)
Bought and viewed Dunn/Vanderpool DVD Hummingbirds of NA. I watched this 7 times
to get key info on tail pumping and markings. As I mentioned... help from CFO
and Cornell with the photos. My initial call was RTHU, but would sometimes think
possible BCHU. The DVD helped with my decision on tail pumping. My thanks go
to Joyce T, Tony L and JVP for their help.
- This report was made from (check one) ☒ notes made during observation, ☐ notes made
after observation. ☐ Later from memory.
- Date of written report: 12-13-2011
- Reporting Observer: Ken Kranik
616 Kiwi Rd
Sterling CO 80751
Email: KStang@rcix.net
970 522-6654

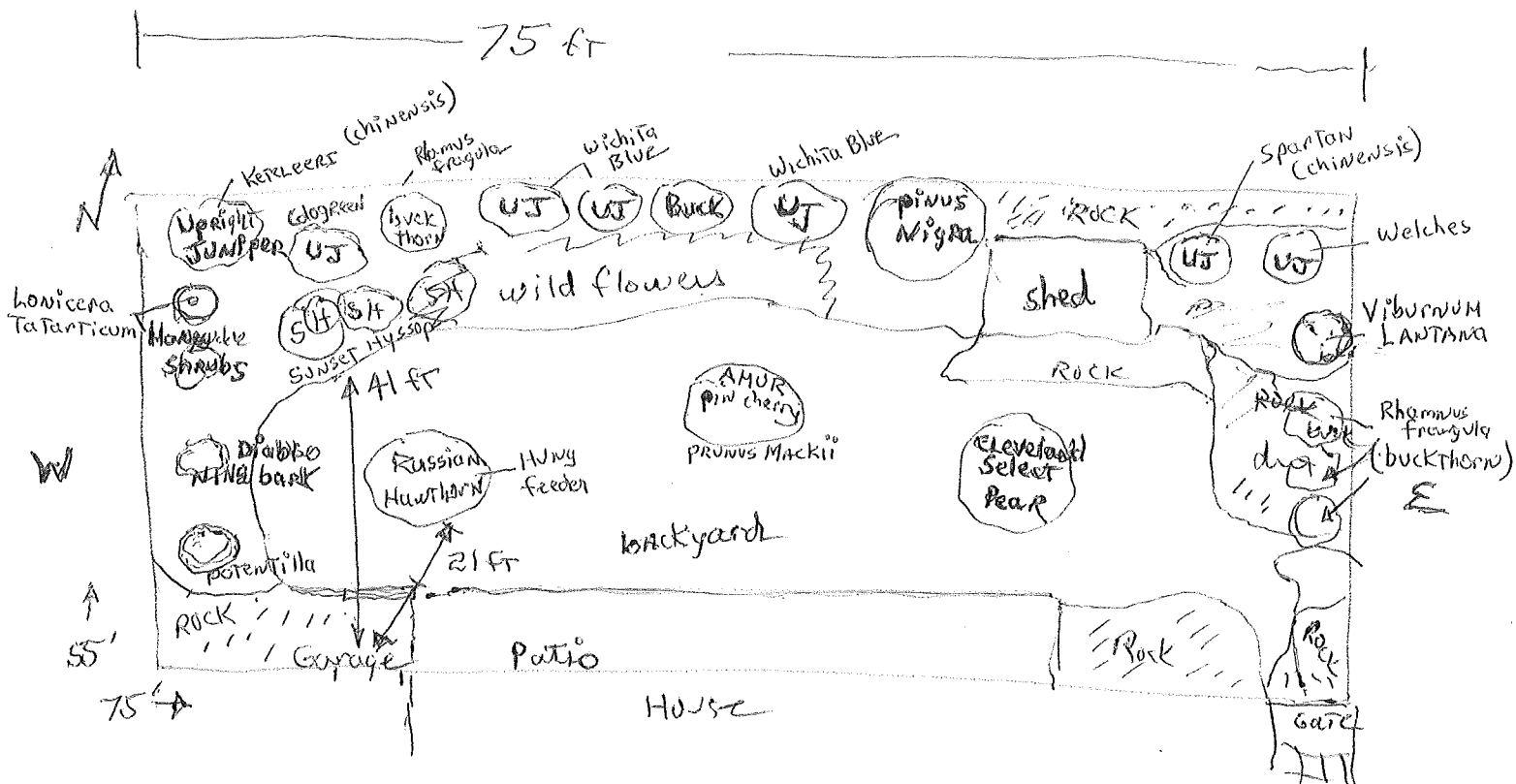
Flowers 46'
- feeder 21'

Plants: wild flowers

Lavender
Red Rocks Penstemon
Yellow Primrose
Zinnia
Russian Sage
Jupiter's Beard
Penstemon Pini folius
Spiderwort

Holbe - W. free 55'

E-W 75°



Doug Faulkner

The last time I was in Touch was with bird reports from Guernsey, WY. (Golden-crowned sparrow, Williamson's Sapsucker) After 31 yrs on the BNSF, I pulled the plug in May 2011. I'll sure miss the great birding in Guernsey. Won't miss Railroading. Those photos of the RTHU were all emailed to Joyce Takimine. She passed them on to Tony Leukering and John Vanderpoel.

I handwrote report as I'm not good with computers. Old school I guess.
Included this sketch of my backyard which was designed for birds
in mind.

Ken Krawik